2009 Toyota Camry LE (115k mi)

$5,800 · 115,000 miles · Private seller · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/bakersfield-2009-toyota-camry-le/nyUZCqxCxyJwbyY15f4BTM

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 2 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$6,562	**$467**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 10 recalls · 1,412 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$5,800.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$536.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$37.70
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$6,562.20
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$1,562.20
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$31.30
Total interest over the loan	$316.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$31.30
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$190.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$95.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.64
Total per month	$466.94

Running costs without the loan: **$436/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$12,048** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good overall, with the same caveat as the Ridgecrest Camry: the 2007-2009 2.4L can burn oil, and dashboards get sticky in desert heat. Lower miles than the local one.

NHTSA data for this model year: 10 recalls · 1,412 owner complaints (160 involving a crash). Most complaints: Vehicle Speed Control (285), Structure (241), Engine (219), Unknown Or Other (183), Service Brakes (166), Visibility/Wiper (100).

Known issues for this model

• 2.4L (2AZ-FE) oil consumption (2007-2009)

• Sticky/melting dashboard in heat

• Water pump leaks

• Recalls: accelerator pedal/floor mat, power-window switch

Check on this car before buying

• Check oil level / blue smoke at startup

• Seller provides the smog certificate

• Inspect the dashboard

• Run VIN for open recalls (free at Toyota dealers)

Notes

$5,800, 115k mi, 4-cylinder, automatic. Clean title, tags until June 2027, 'smog check ready'. Condition listed 'like new'.

Compare: the Ridgecrest 2009 Camry is $5,000 with 148k mi - this one has 33k fewer miles for $800 more.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.